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RECOMMENDATION · NOVEMBER 3, 2026

Hosting and newsletter options

Prepared for 6311Arts.com

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AGENDA

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What we will cover today

Short-term WordPress hosting and the newsletter platform, priced and compared

1. **At a glance**
   The two decisions and our answer
2. **Hosting**
   Bluehost, WordPress.com and Azure side by side
3. **Newsletter**
   Mailchimp and Kit side by side
4. **Cost-benefit**
   What each option costs and what it buys
5. **Recommendation**
   What we pick and what happens next

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At a glance

The two decisions and our answer

Stay on WordPress.com until Rogers Edge launches, and start Kit on its free plan now.

01 · AT A GLANCE

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Two decisions, two short answers

HOSTING

Stay on WordPress.com

- No migration for a site with a short life
- Already managed, cached and on a CDN
- $25 to $45 a month on its current plan tier

NEWSLETTER

Start Kit on the free plan

- Free for up to 10,000 subscribers
- The platform the Rogers Edge SOW names
- Creator from $39 a month when we need it

THE WINDOW

Short term means 3 to 6 months

- Rogers Edge UAT runs into January 2027
- WordPress retires once the new site is live
- Every hosting dollar here is a bridge cost

WHY NOT MOVE

A move costs more than it saves

- Bluehost and Azure both need a full migration
- Checkout, FooEvents and redirects retested
- The best prices need a 12 to 36 month prepay

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Hosting

Bluehost, WordPress.com and Azure side by side

All three run WordPress and WooCommerce. They differ on who maintains it and how long you commit.

02 · HOSTING

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Three ways to host WordPress

WORDPRESS.COM

Managed, and already home

- Business $25 or Commerce $45 a month, yearly
- Updates, backups, caching and CDN included
- Month to month: $40 Business, $70 Commerce

BLUEHOST

Cheapest sticker, long commitment

- eCommerce Essentials $14.99 a month on 36 months
- Renews at $21.99; month to month is $32.99
- Shared servers; backups are a $2.99 add-on

AZURE

Most control, most upkeep

- App Service plus MySQL, billed by the hour
- Basic about $21 a month; Standard about $139
- Plugin, theme, PHP and backup care is ours

WORDPRESS.ORG

A note on WordPress.org

- WordPress.org is the free software, not a host
- Bluehost and Azure both run WordPress.org
- WordPress.com is Automattic's managed host

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Hosting side by side

	WordPress.com	Bluehost	Azure App Service
Plan that fits	Business or Commerce	eCommerce Essentials	Basic (B1) or Standard (P1v2)
Month to month	$40 to $70	$32.99	About $21 Basic, $139 Standard
Best rate	$25 to $45 a month, paid yearly	$14.99 a month, 36 months prepaid	Pay as you go, no prepay
Performance	Global CDN and edge cache built in	Shared server, varies with neighbours	Good on Standard; Basic is thin for checkout
Upkeep	Handled by WordPress.com	Core updates automatic; the rest is ours	Plugins, themes, PHP and backups are ours
Migration	None, already live	2 to 3 days plus a full retest	3 to 5 days plus a full retest

List prices in USD, November 2026, before tax. Azure figures are Microsoft's East US estimates for its WordPress plans.

02 · HOSTING · PERFORMANCE

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Fast enough without paying for a move

WHAT MATTERS SHORT TERM

- ✓ *Class pages and checkout stay fast through the spring*
- ✓ *Staff keep editing the way they do today*
- ✓ *Nothing to unwind when Rogers Edge goes live*

HOW EACH ONE MEETS IT

- ★ *WordPress.com already has the CDN and page cache*
- ★ *Bluehost shared hosting adds risk, not speed*
- ★ *Azure Basic is underpowered; Standard costs 3 to 5x more*

Speed today is held back by the plugin stack, not the host. The audit's cleanup sprint is the cheaper speed fix.

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Newsletter

Mailchimp and Kit side by side

Both send newsletters and automations well. They differ on price, free tiers and fit with Square and the new CMS.

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Two strong tools, different strengths

MAILCHIMP

Broad and well known

- 15% nonprofit discount with a 501(c)(3) letter
- Free Square sync on any paid plan
- Official WooCommerce plugin

MAILCHIMP

Where it costs more

- The free plan stops at 500 contacts
- Unsubscribed contacts still count toward the bill
- Standard is $60 a month at 2,500 contacts

KIT

A generous free plan

- Free for up to 10,000 subscribers
- Unlimited sends, forms and landing pages
- Integrations and full automations need Creator

KIT

Fits the plan we already have

- Named in the Rogers Edge SOW
- Official WooCommerce plugin on Creator
- Square links through the CMS or Zapier

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What each costs at our list size

Per month	Mailchimp Essentials	Mailchimp Standard	Kit Newsletter	Kit Creator
Small list	$11 (500 contacts)	$17 (500 contacts)	$0	$33 (1,000)
Medium list	$38 (2,500)	$51 (2,500)	$0	About $50 (3,000)
Large list	$64 (5,000)	$85 (5,000)	$0	About $75 (5,000)
Automations	Single-step only	Multi-step	1 automation, 1 sequence	Unlimited
Square	Native sync	Native sync	None	Through CMS or Zapier
WooCommerce	Official plugin	Official plugin	None	Official plugin

Mailchimp prices include the 15% nonprofit discount. Kit Creator prices are billed yearly; Kit decides nonprofit discounts case by case.

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Cost-benefit

What each option costs and what it buys

We priced a six-month bridge, November through April, plus the one-time effort of moving.

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Six months of hosting, priced

Option	6 months of hosting	Move effort	Performance	Upkeep	Verdict
WordPress.com, stay	**$0 to $420**	**None**	**Good**	**Low**	**Recommended**
Bluehost, month to month	About $200	2 to 3 days	Fair	Medium	Not worth the move
Bluehost, 36-month prepay	$540 up front	2 to 3 days	Fair	Medium	Pays for 30 unused months
Azure Basic	About $126	3 to 5 days	Thin for checkout	High	Too small for WooCommerce
Azure Standard	About $834	3 to 5 days	Good	High	Power we won't keep

WordPress.com costs $0 more if the current yearly plan runs past April. Move days come out of the $12,500 Rogers Edge budget.

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Kit wins on cost and fit

MAILCHIMP BUYS YOU

- ✓ *Native Square sync without custom work*
- ✓ *A tool most staff and volunteers already know*
- ✓ *About $51 a month at 2,500 contacts, after discount*

KIT BUYS YOU

- ★ *$0 today, for up to 10,000 subscribers*
- ★ *One platform for the bridge and for Rogers Edge*
- ★ *Creator at about $50 a month, only when needed*

Twelve months at about 2,500 contacts: Mailchimp Standard about $612, Kit free $0, Kit Creator about $600.

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Recommendation

What we pick and what happens next

Stay on WordPress.com through launch. Move the newsletter to Kit now, so the list is ready for Rogers Edge.

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Our recommendation

HOSTING

Stay on WordPress.com

- Keep the current plan; skip a new yearly renewal
- Run the audit's cleanup sprint for speed
- Cancel once Rogers Edge is live on Azure

NEWSLETTER

Start Kit on the free plan

- Import the MailPoet list and sign-up forms
- Send the monthly newsletter from Kit
- Move to Creator when automations start

NOT DOING

What we are leaving out

- Bluehost: long prepay, slower shared servers
- WordPress on Azure: upkeep for a short life
- Mailchimp: paying for a list we'd move again

ROGERS EDGE

How it lines up

- Azure hosts the new site, as the SOW plans
- The CMS sends sign-ups to Kit through its API
- Square stays the payment system

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Next steps

THIS WEEK

- ✓ *Check the WordPress.com plan and renewal date*
- ✓ *Ask Kit about a nonprofit discount*
- ✓ *Export the MailPoet subscriber list*

BEFORE LAUNCH

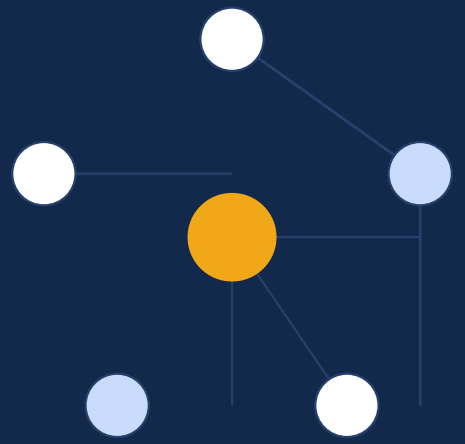
- ★ *Run PageSpeed on Home, Classes and Shop*
- ★ *Connect the CMS sign-up form to Kit*
- ★ *Set the WordPress.com cancel date after go-live*

Sources: WordPress.com, Bluehost, Microsoft, Mailchimp and Kit pricing pages and reviews, read Nov 3, 2026.

LET'S TALK

Questions?

Push on the numbers, the trade-offs and the timing — that's what this conversation is for.



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